Equal Level Conversion

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"Equal Level Conversion" is a rebid after an opposing takeout double to show 5-4 shape in the unbid suits. Specifically, it is used after your right-hand opponent ("RHO") opens 1♥/♠, you double, and partner responds 2♣.

	RHO	You	LHO	Partner
♠AJ43	1♥	Dbl	Pass	2♣
♥76	Pass	2♦ [1]		
♦AT953				
♣A5				

(1) Equal Level Conversion, showing 5-4 in diamonds and spades.

	RHO	You	LHO	Partner
♠93	1♠	Dbl	Pass	2♣
♥AJ43	Pass	2♦ [1]		
♦KQT53				
♣A5				

(1) Equal Level Conversion, showing 5-4 in diamonds and hearts.

The benefit of Equal Level Conversion is increased bidding flexibility. With a 4-5 hand, you can make a takeout double with club shortness. The 2♦ is your outlet bid if partner happens to bid clubs.

The drawback to Equal Level Conversion is that you can no longer play 2♦ in the above auctions as a strong one-suiter in diamonds. You must jump-rebid 3♦ instead.

See also

- Raptor 1NT
  A direct, artificial 1NT overcall that shows 4-5 shape.
- Takeout Double
  A conventional double that asks partner to bid one of the unbid suits.